Bright-room bar palettes

For charts shown in a brightly lit room. Each palette adds one color to the previous one, so a series keeps its color as bars are added. Use text #222222 and gridlines #E2E7EE on every background.

1 bar palette

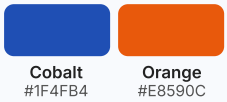
Background: LED white #F8FAFD



Single series or a total. Cobalt reads strongly under bright light without glare.

2 bar palette

Background: LED white #F8FAFD



A/B tests, before vs. after, actual vs. target. Blue and orange are opposites and colorblind-safe.

3 bar palette

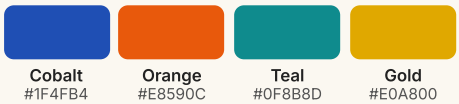
Background: LED white #F8FAFD



Low / mid / high, or three segments. Teal sits between blue and orange so all three stay distinct.

4 bar palette

Background: Milky white #FBF8F1



Quarterly views or four channels. Gold adds a warm accent; label gold bars in dark text.

5 bar palette

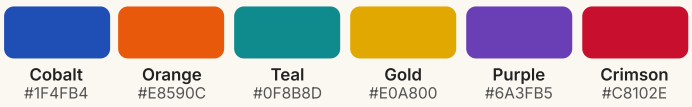
Background: Milky white #FBF8F1



Five categories or regions. Purple keeps it cool-warm balanced. Background shifts to milky white to soften glare.

6 bar palette

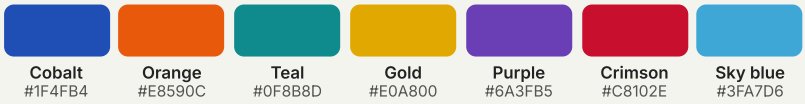
Background: Milky white #FBF8F1



Six product lines or segments. Crimson is the last strongly distinct hue; good upper limit for legends.

7 bar palette

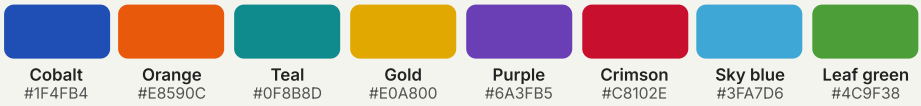
Background: Moon white #F4F4EE



Weekdays or seven groups. Sky blue is lighter than cobalt so they still separate. Moon white background.

8 bar palette

Background: Moon white #F4F4EE



Eight categories. Leaf green differs from teal by brightness; label bars directly rather than via legend.

9 bar palette

Background: Moon white #F4F4EE



Nine groups. Magenta is close to crimson, so keep them apart in order and add direct labels.

10 bar palette

Background: Moon white #F4F4EE



Maximum set. Slate gray works well for 'Other' or a baseline series. Beyond 10, group small categories.

Tips: keep backgrounds off-white, not pure white, to cut glare. Saturated, mid-to-dark bars hold up under bright light; avoid pastels. Past 6 colors, label bars directly.